

ACTIVITY 3 — LEARNER WORKSHEET

Brand Attribute Mapping

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Case Study	30 minutes	LU1	LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

For the relaunch, the founder wants one page that finally settles what Nimbus stands for — because right now the brand isn't described the same way twice. Retail calls it "affordable self-care." Marketing calls it "clean beauty for real skin." Customer Service calls it "the brand that actually replies."

What you will produce: A two-column attribute map (3 hard → 3 soft) with one approved brand concept line and the CBBE level it strengthens.

The scenario

Your table must map Nimbus's hard attributes (the real product facts) and soft attributes (the feelings those facts create) into one brand concept the founder can approve — and that all three teams could say in their own words.

Your steps

1. **Write up the three current descriptions** — Put Retail's "affordable self-care", Marketing's "clean beauty for real skin" and Customer Service's "the brand that actually replies" at the top of your sheet. These are your evidence that the brand is currently undefined.
2. **List candidate hard attributes** — Brainstorm the measurable, provable facts about the Nimbus range — ingredient standards, price point, response times, packaging, formulation claims. Apply one test to each: could you put a number or a verifiable statement against it? If not, it is a soft attribute pretending to be a hard one.
3. **Select your three hard attributes** — Choose the three that Nimbus can genuinely claim AND that a customer would care about. Something true but irrelevant does not earn a place on the map.
4. **Derive the soft attribute from each hard one** — For each hard attribute ask "so what does that make the customer FEEL?" Draw an arrow to the soft attribute. Fast replies → feeling heard. Clean formulation → feeling safe. Accessible price → feeling the brand is for people like me.

5. **Test the soft attributes against the three teams** — Compare your soft attributes with what Retail, Marketing and Customer Service each say. Where a team's description has no matching soft attribute on your map, decide: is the team wrong, or is your map incomplete?
6. **Place Nimbus on the CBBE pyramid** — Work up Keller's levels — Salience (are we noticed?), Performance and Imagery (are we understood?), Judgments and Feelings (are we felt?), Resonance (are we recommended?). Mark the level where Nimbus is weakest today and note the evidence.
7. **Draft the brand concept line** — Write one line the founder could approve. It must connect at least one hard attribute to its soft attribute. Then stress-test it: could Retail, Marketing AND Customer Service each restate it in their own words without contradicting each other? If not, redraft.

Your working space

Complete every field. You may keep this worksheet and refer to it during the open-book assessment.

Step 1 — Write up the three current descriptions

Step 2 — List candidate hard attributes

Step 3 — Select your three hard attributes

Step 4 — Derive the soft attribute from each hard one

Step 5 — Test the soft attributes against the three teams

Step 6 — Place Nimbus on the CBBE pyramid

Step 7 — Draft the brand concept line

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. What are three hard attributes (measurable facts) Nimbus can genuinely claim about its skincare range?

2. What soft attribute — the feeling — does each hard attribute actually create, and is it the same feeling Retail, Marketing and Customer Service currently describe?

3. Using Keller's Brand Equity Pyramid, which level is Nimbus weakest at right now: being noticed (Salience), understood (Performance/Imagery), felt (Judgments/Feelings), or trusted enough to be recommended (Resonance)?

4. What single brand concept line could the founder approve that all three teams could restate consistently?

Reflect & discuss

Was it harder for your table to agree on the hard attributes or the soft attributes — and why?

Which pyramid level did your table disagree about the most?

If a customer only ever experienced Nimbus through a five-minute Customer Service chat, which attribute would that conversation need to prove true?

Check your work

Every group can show 3 hard + 3 soft attributes connected to one brand concept line, and can name the CBBE pyramid level the concept is designed to strengthen.